

Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

October 2026



£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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From our Vicar

Dear Friends

In his essay 'On Fairy Stories', J. R. R. Tolkien, that extraordinary writer of fantasy stories, argues that this sort of narrative is more than just something to occupy a bored child, or an adult who feels that the demands of reality are too great and therefore escape is all that makes life bearable. The role that 'fairy stories' play, declares Tolkien is to 'reawaken' us to the fact that actually the real world is pretty fantastic as well. This 'reawakening' he describes as 'Recovery' or 're-gaining of a clear view'. He argues that we need to 'clean our windows' – to look once again at the surroundings of our daily lives, seeing them with 'fresh eyes'. We should pay attention to the everyday and the familiar, taking time to notice them and truly appreciate them in all their splendour. 'We should look at green again,' he wrote 'and be startled anew (but not blinded) by blue and yellow and red. Recovery (which includes return and renewal of health) is a re-gaining—regaining of a clear view.'

As our memories of that long, hot summer fade, may we rejoice in the golds and reds and oranges of autumn. May we celebrate the sound of dead leaves beneath our feet, smell the crisp air and listen to the birds that provide a constant background noise which may have grown too familiar for us to notice.

And, since 'cleaning our windows' applies to familiar faces as well as familiar surroundings, may we recognise and truly appreciate those with whom we share our lives, being grateful for signs of love and affection, and offering them in return.

All good gifts around us are sent from heaven above

Then thank the Lord, O thank the Lord, for all his love (Matthias Claudius)

Sally



Trefoil Guild

Kington

The Trefoil Guild is a friendly community for anyone aged 18+ who enjoys friendship, fun, food and fellowship. Whether you've been involved in Guiding before or are simply looking for a friendly group to join, you're very welcome to come along.

Our next meeting is **Wednesday 28th October from 2.00–4.00pm** at Markwick Close Hall, Kington. We'll have a short meeting followed by a Beetle Drive and a "Guess Who?" photo challenge. Bring along a photo of yourself as a child and see if the group can figure out who's who! After our activities we'll share in a cuppa and a delicious treat.

For more information, contact Sally: sally@leitch.me.uk or 07765 056386

From the Archdeacon of Hereford

Anniversary

I wonder how many of you look up dates to see what happened on them? If you love history you already know that 87 years ago the Britain declared war on Nazi Germany for invading Poland. The Second World War ended in 1945 and peace was maintained in Europe despite the Cold War until Russia invaded Ukraine.

In many ways anniversary dates often remind us of significant events in history or things closer to home like weddings or birthdays and I think we find these easier to mark because we are involved and invested in them. In churches we have festivals which help remind ourselves us of the Christian story. From a spiritual perspective, if you were to look for them there is almost a Saints day for every day of the year! We are about to enter a season of Harvest Festivals, All Souls tide and Remembrance Sunday, as human being we love to find reasons to celebrate anniversaries and significant dates.

“One person esteems one day as better than another; while another esteems all days alike. Each one should be fully convinced in his own mind. The one who observes the day, observes it in honour of the Lord. The one who eats, eats in honour of the Lord, since he gives thanks to God, while the one who abstains, abstains in honour of the Lord and gives thanks to God.” Romans 14:5-6

Paul writing to the church in Rome says to them that how we mark anniversaries or which anniversaries doesn't actually matter in God's kingdom but it is the attitude of the heart that matters. Paul didn't condemn the people for marking days or celebrating special anniversaries instead he reminds them that we need to honour God in all that we do.

“I hate, I despise your religious festivals; your assemblies are a stench to me. Even though you bring me burnt offerings and

grain offerings, I will not accept them. Though you bring choice fellowship offerings, I will have no regard for them. Away with the noise of your songs!

I will not listen to the music of your harps. But let justice roll on like a river; righteousness like a never-failing stream!” Amos 5:21-24

In the book of Amos God tells the people through the prophet that he has no time for their religious feasts, festivals and anniversaries because of their attitude towards others. If we do not allow God to change our hearts and minds then our religious festivals and ceremonies are meaningless. It is the very thing that Jesus condemns the religious people of his time for doing and what Paul warns Timothy against.

“People will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boastful, proud, abusive, disobedient to their parents, ungrateful, unholy, without love, unforgiving, slanderous, without self-control, brutal, not lovers of the good, treacherous, rash, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God— having a form of godliness but denying its power. Have nothing to do with such people.” 2 Timothy 3:2-5

Our faith is primarily lived out everyday and whilst festivals and anniversaries help us remember the faith story when they become more important than our faith we are in danger of swapping human rules and regulations for spiritual realities.

The Venerable Derek Chedzey

Archdeacon of Hereford



Kington Parishes: October 2026

Sunday, 4th Trinity 18

11.00am:	Harvest Festival and Lunch:	Kington*
6.00pm:	Harvest Festival and Supper:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Praise and Prayer Evening:	Kington

Friday, 9th

6.00pm:	Harvest Festival and Supper	Titely
6.00pm:	Harvest Festival and Supper	Kinnerton

Sunday, 11th Trinity 19

Isaiah 25:1-9, Psalm 23, Phillippians 4:1-9, Matthew 22:1-4

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington*
11.00am:	Harvest Festival:	Huntington
11:30am	Holy Communion:	Old Radnor

Sunday, 18th Luke the Evangelist

Isaiah 35:3-6, Psalm 147:1-7, 2 Timothy 4:5-17, Luke 10:1-9

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titely
10.00am:	Morning Praise:	Kington*
12.30pm	Wild Church Cookout	Kington
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Old Radnor

Sunday, 25th Last After Trinity

Leviticus 19:1-2, 15-18, Psalm 1, 1Thessalonians 2:1-8, Matthew 24:30-35

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington*
6.00pm:	Sung Evensong:	Huntington

WEEKDAY SERVICES

Morning Prayer takes place at 9am in Kington every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, and Evening Prayer at 4pm on Mondays. All are welcome.

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

St. Mary's Church, Kington

Harvest Festival

This will be held on Sunday October 4th, at 11am in St. Mary's, followed by a Bring and Share lunch. Do come and see the church decorated for Harvest and stay for lunch – don't worry if you nothing to bring towards lunch, there is always enough for all. There will also be a harvest sales table as usual.

Hergest Croft Autumn Fair

We are hoping to run a Cake and Bake stall at the autumn fair on Sunday 11th October, from 10am, in aid of church funds.

Concert, Friday 16th October

Our October concert is entitled 'A Jug of Punch' and will be at 7pm in church. A mixture of instrumental pieces, songs, poetry, string and piano pieces, organ music, and the first performance of the Marches Voices choir, newly formed in Kington. There will be something for everyone, do come along.

Church tiles

It is hoped that the restoration of the newly uncovered tiles in church will begin during the first week of November. The church will have to be shut occasionally for a day or two to allow for ventilation of the building. This will be clearly signposted outside the church. Services will not be affected. We are greatly looking forward to seeing the tiles in their former glory again.

Church ceiling

This is ongoing, still in the investigation phase as I write this...

Our other activities are happening as usual this autumn.

Stay and Play on Tuesday mornings at 9.15 in the Parish Hall, during term time.

Beetle Drives on the second Tuesday at 7pm in the Parish Hall



– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 21st October

3:30pm – 5:00pm

St Marys Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available
legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together

Lego, usually the third Wednesday at 3.30pm in the Church.

We do hope you will be able to come to some of our activities, and also to join us for our Sunday services if you wish – generally Holy Communion at 10am, with Morning Praise at 10am on the 3rd Sunday.

With best wishes to you all,

With our best wishes as always to you all,
Margaret Cooke and Greg Wright,
churchwardens.

Music at St. Mary's

Our October concert, on Friday 16th at 7pm is a 'A Jug of Punch'. A mixture of instrumental pieces, solo song, Poetry reading, String and piano quartets, organ music and the first performance of a newly formed choir in Kington - Marches Voices. Something for everyone. All washed down with a choice of drinks from our jugs of punch!



St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

Summer Weddings:

Huntington has had two weddings this summer. The first wedding was Andrew Watson to Lucy Blaine, who both live in

Huntington. The second, at the beginning of the August bank holiday weekend, was Sophie Jones who married Jack Hughes. Sophie was born in Huntington and met Jack at school, they plan to live in Huntington. The rings were carried up the aisle by their black labrador. With the church filled to capacity and two gazebos in the churchyard for extra guests, Rev. Judith Pollard conducted the service, accompanied at the organ by Bill Dunn, who did a splendid job. Sophie had grown many of the flowers herself, which decorated the church beautifully. It seemed the whole village turned out to wish them well. We wish both couples every happiness in their married lives together.



Huntington Chase

**Saturday 3rd October 2026
at 12 noon**

Ride, bike, run or walk - 11km. course.

Start Huntington Village Hall, on to Gypsy Lane,
Hergest Ridge, Gladestry, Stone House Bank and back.

Numbers will be limited.

To book a place, complete details in

<https://www.huntingtonchurch.co.uk/chase-2026>

£15 entry to include soup and sandwich.

Under 16's free but must be accompanied;

Swan Inn will be open.

Fancy dress encouraged and prizes.

For any queries contact

peterbkelly642@hotmail.com

Sponsored by
S W Maddy & Son Automotive &
Diagnostic Specialists



All proceeds to
St Thomas a Becket Church
and The Dove Project

Riders and cyclists to wear protective head gear. Riders must carry own PL insurance. All to take own personal accident insurance if desired and to declare they are in good health and not suffering any medical condition or physical handicap which would affect their ability to take part safely in this event.

If you live in the Kington Benefice and are planning on a wedding, it is possible to get married in any of the churches within the Benefice. St Thomas a Becket in Huntington is the perfect country idyl and offers a beautiful smaller space for a more intimate wedding celebration.

Huntington Chase

– Saturday 3rd October

– 12:00 noon:

Just a reminder there is still time to book a place on the Huntington Chase, or to just come along and spectate. See poster on the left for further information.

Harvest Festival:

The Huntington Harvest Festival will be held at the URC Church on Sunday 11th October, at 11:00am and the service will be taken by Rev. Phillippa Wright.

Susan Maiden



St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

Sunday 18th October 10am: Judith.

Winter Services

Please do not forget that between October and April there will only be one service held in the church, that being the third Sunday at 10am. This is primarily to try and save some money on heating etc. Never forget there are always other services held each Sunday in other churches if you would like to attend those.

Village Fete

I can now report that we have the final figure from the fete and the fantastic sum of £3,207.42 was raised at our Village Fete this year. Many thanks to everyone who helped to make this happen. This will now be equally divided between the Hall and Church.

Harvest Festival

This year's Harvest Festival takes place in the church at 6pm on Friday 30th October. This is always a lovely service and well attended. After the service we will adjourn to the Village Hall for a Harvest Supper. Please come along and celebrate this special occasion.

Many thanks

Dick



**Saturday
10th October 7.30pm.
Music in New Radnor**

'A Trio of Friends'

For the first concert of the new season, flautist Wendy Quinlan and 'cellist Richard Tunncliffe will join Ruth Watson (oboe and cor anglais) for a varied programme of solos, duos and trio pieces, by composers including JS Bach, Arthur Honegger and Heitor (Hector) Villa Lobos. Also included in the programme will be the premiere of a specially commissioned work for this concert, composed by Richard Errington local composer, pianist and former chorister at Hereford Cathedral.

**New Radnor Community Hall,
Hall Lane, New Radnor, Powys,
LD8 2SW**

Pre-booking preferred if possible

Tickets £15 (under 14s, £3)
from 01544 350746 or 07493 940683
Doors open at 7pm for a 7.30 start.

Reader Writes

Dear Yumans, or may I say Dear Yuman Neighbours, and maybe I could even go so far as to address you as Dear Friends and Protectors. This is your local Rat Commissar given authority by the Rat Powers in this region to address you formally on a subject that is worrying you hugely and should be worrying you too. When it comes to us rats you will be aware that there is little or nothing that concerns us more than food!

Access to food, quantities of food and nutritional quality of food govern our success or otherwise in breeding and maintaining a re-ratable population in a position to keep your food waste to a minimum.

Let me come to the point directly. Our squeakably reliable rat archives are establishing that this summer has been a record for high temperatures and low rainfall. Those who have travelled on ships to Espania, tell us that our dried yellow grass and hungry cattle are what you expect in Andalucía. There they breed wiry fighting bulls; here we “fatten” beef cattle for the oven. But worryingly, as we understand it, Herefordshire farmers are already feeding winter stores of hay, silage and grain to keep stock going until it rains and the grass grows while there’s a little summer left.

As you know, the UK imports 60% of its food requirements in general, but we produce over 80% of our own cereals. We are self-sufficient in milk and lamb, and we could become self-sufficient in eggs, poultry and beef. But those products are dependent on imported feed, often grown on land illegally cleared of forest. So, Dear Yumans, we wish to point

out to you some theology that is more than obvious to us rats. We, after all, are used to surviving, even thriving, where we depend upon each other.

The earth is not yours to do with as you like! It belongs to the God of all creation who made man and rats, and was generous enough to have placed us both within it. We enjoy the image of the Garden of Eden where Adam and Eve could roam in friendship with God.

**“You have given him
dominion over the works
of your hands, you have
put all things under his
feet, all sheep and oxen,
and also the beasts of
the field (that’s us), the
birds of the heavens,
and the fish of the sea.”**

Rat mythology tells that we were there too, even then establishing the principle of sharing and tidying up leftovers. You should know and treasure this truth in *Psalm 24:1* “*The earth is the Lord’s and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell therein.*”

We are not owners but God’s stewards, or if you like, his servants. Now, perhaps, it is fair to say, it is you Yumans,

who have responsibility for creation care. It is your task to manage the earth sustainably. You will understand our concern that you should do your job successfully, then we shall all be able to survive, even thrive, on the bounty of the earth without destroying it. Our rat philosophers like very much *Psalm 8:6-8* “*You have given him dominion over the works of your hands, you have put all things under his feet, all sheep and oxen, and also the beasts of the field (that’s us), the birds of the heavens, and the fish of the sea.*” Thank you Yumans; please take more thorough care of our earth as God’s stewards; Your humble Rat Commissar is grateful.

Robert MacCurrach

God by Numbers

10 The ten ‘God said’ phrases of the Genesis creation story are paired by ancient commentators with the Ten Commandments spoken to Moses. These divine utterances are seen as partners in bringing order to chaos.

In Exodus, 10 plagues amplify God’s ‘Let my people go!’ And result in freedom from their Egyptian oppressors. Their short-lived gratitude lengthens a 10-day journey into 40 years! Of 10 lepers healed, Jesus notes only one, the despised, impure Samaritan, the ‘foreigner’, returns to give thanks. Gratitude is an essential oil in the works of life and eases the journey.

10 virgins waited for the bridegroom. Only 5 were prepared for him to come in the dead of night. They trimmed their lamps and bought expensive oil in expectation. The wishful thinking of the other five, who hoped he would arrive conveniently in daylight, ran into darkness. We need to fuel our imagination in days of waiting gloom with some subversive acts of illuminating hope.

Christ’s parables of lost things found include a woman’s search for a missing silver coin. One of 10, so likely part of her treasured bridal headband. Her search involves burning oil to dispel the darkness hiding it. She throws an ‘I-found-it!’ party to celebrate, costing her far more than the coin itself. God makes a costly search for every one of us, passionate to lead us from captivity in chaos to freedom in peace. God says to every oppressive captor, “Let my people go”.

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

Visit

Kington Art and Craft Market

Saturday 17th October

9:30am – 3:00pm

Kington Market Hall
and Place de Marines.

Kington Art & Craft Market

supports local Artists and Crafters and offers a wide variety of unique items. We have something for everyone. You will also find some of the crafters demonstrating their skills.

Our stalls offer basketry, crochet & knitted items, papercraft and cards, pottery,

wood turning, stone painting, engraving, jewellery, works from local artists and honey products plus a lot more. It is the perfect place to find a Birthday, Wedding

Gift or Cards or can I even mention the word, Christmas.

So please put Sat 19th September into your diary and come and say Hello.

***We look forward
to seeing you***

A JUG OF PUNCH

St Mary's Church, Kington



A lively evening of a variety of music, voices, handbells, solo songs, instrumental pieces, poetry readings and audience participation. All washed down with a drink from one of our jugs of punch.

SOMETHING FOR EVERYONE!!!

Friday 16 October | 7:00 PM

Come along, bring your friends, and enjoy a memorable night of music and fun in the heart of Kington. ADMISSION FREE. Donations on the night welcome. All proceeds to the church organ fund.

Operation Dove

Since I wrote last on 10th August a lot has been happening at the Dove and Yarn Barn. In the Dove, the floor has been repaired, the ceiling has been boarded with extra fire-retardant plasterboard and then plastered, the walls have been repaired and part panelled, and all surfaces have been painted. The electricians have been busy completely renewing all the wiring, installing a new consumer unit and running the cables for the fire alarm system. All of this work was completed in time for the open day on 23rd August, and quite a number of people came in to admire the new appearance of the former pub and to see the display boards showing before and after views of the buildings. It is hoped that the small kitchenette will be installed soon and that carpet tiles will be laid once the last of the decoration has been completed.

During the open day, which took place as part of the Kington Street Market, we ran a cake stall and yard sale in the courtyard. The Yarn Barn was used for refreshments all day, with cream teas in the afternoon, and a total of £504.00 was raised for church funds. This clearly demonstrated the possibilities for activities benefiting both the church and the community across all parts of 37 High Street.

In the Yarn Barn the stairs to the upper floor storage area should soon

be installed allowing the Yarn Barn to go from strength to strength, as we will be able to store more craft equipment. Our visitors have been learning several different craft activities. These include pin weaving, wool preparation using both hand and drum carders for carding and blending wool, spinning on a drop spindle or spinning wheel, making Dorset buttons and Japanese braiding on a Marudai. There are still a lot more activities that we can offer, so the future looks very exciting.

Freda and Alison
yarnbarn37@gmail.com

In aid of The Dove & Yarn Barn renovations



Coffee Morning



at

**The Dove & Yarn Barn
37 High St, Kington**

**10am - 12noon
Saturday 17th October**

**Coffee * Tea * Raffle
Bring & Buy * Tombola
Quiz * Cake Stall**

**Free Entry
All Welcome**

MONTHLY MUSINGS

Hymn for Michaelmas. (29th September) Suggested tune, Solothurn.

*Before September goes her way
she opens wide the young man's eyes
to see how Michael fills the skies
with heaven's angelic host this day
who tarry there with swords of flame,
and safe deliverance afford
to all who call upon the Lord
to all who fear his Holy Name.*

*who tarry there with swords of flame,
and safe deliverance afford
to all who call upon the Lord
to all who fear his Holy Name.*

Autumn. Michaelmas, and I'm musingly back at the College of St. Michael and All Angels Tenbury where, for eight happy years in the sixties I lived, taught up to Common Entrance, sang tenor in 13 fully choral services a week, and enjoyed so many activities with the boys and friendly staff: all the usual games plus scouting, hiking, building dens in the wood, swimming, playing on the pond, camping at weekends etc. And I recall one very hard winter when the Cadmore Brook was frozen solid for us to enjoy. Matron, my future wife, had plenty to keep her busy – good practice for looking after her family!

The college was founded by Ouseley to encourage and support cathedral music, which was then in the doldrums. He appointed 16 year old Stainer (of future Crucifixion fame) as organist for the magnificent Father Willis organ. Ouseley also established a famous music library much used by musicologists from near and far, including our neighbour Watkins Shaw. Emma has just found for me on You Tube an end of term Good Friday

*A myriad thoughts angelified
in Gabriel's silver wings God sends,
while Raphael help and healing lends,
who, incognito, walks beside.
Young man, fear not! the dream is true,
For Christ, the Ladder; earthward brings
the host which Holy, Holy sings:
th' angelic vision is for you!*

*Young man, fear not! the dream is true,
For Christ, the Ladder; earthward brings
the host which Holy, Holy sings:
th' angelic vision is for you!*

service from 1964 which I must have sung in (search for “St Michael's Tenbury 1964”).

But what about believing in St Michael and his accompanying angels? He, of course, is an archangel, one of the three – the other two are named in my hymn. Back in the good old Dark Ages, one of our unmissable programmes on the Wireless, Home Service, was the Brains' Trust, where Professor Joad would get things going by responding to a question like that above by beginning with his favourite phrase “It all depends upon what you mean by....” in this case “angels”? or perhaps “believing in”. And of course he was quite right. In the end each of us must decide for him/her self. The Biblical narrative is certainly full of angelic beings, fulfilling important tasks in the Name of the Father. So what do you think? I have, in Morning Prayer, just read Acts 12 as the N.T. lesson. The angels seem to have been extra busy in the early church. Perhaps we simply live in an unhelpfully sceptical environment, inclined to throw out the baby with bathwater!

Denis Parry

From Lady Hawkins School

Starting secondary school is an exciting milestone, filled with new experiences, new friendships and new opportunities. For our Year 7 students, this new chapter has brought challenges to overcome, lessons to learn and countless opportunities to grow in confidence.

As part of their English work on 'New Beginnings,' our Year 7 students have reflected on their experiences of making the transition to secondary school and looked ahead to the hopes, dreams and aspirations they have for their futures. Their writing captures the mixture of excitement and uncertainty that comes with starting something new, while also showing their determination to embrace new opportunities and achieve their goals.

We are delighted to share the work of Jared Espanola and I hope you enjoy reading his reflections on where his journey has begun with us and where he hopes it will take him.

Miss Moss

A New Beginning

The moment I ventured through the school gates, I knew everything had changed. I was contemplating whether I should run back home but I wouldn't let the worries take control of me. I was flamboyant, anxious and determined, all at the same time.

At first, secondary school felt like stepping through a rift into a new dimension. The building seemed gigantic, the timetable was confusing and every classroom seemed overwhelming. But, I have gained more friendships and exciting experiences.

Of course, starting a new school is not easy. However, these missions and challenges have taught me greater independence and determination.

Now, I am ambitious and I am chasing my dreams and achieving my goals. I feel a sense of confidence, pride and excitement and I hope to be confident and prouder than ever here at Lady Hawkins' School. I know there will be difficult moments, but I will overcome them all.

This is only the beginning.

Jared Espanola

October

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kington and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

Rita Langford

01544 230562

Adrian Wilcox

kingtoncommunityshop@outlook.com

Kington & District Community Shop

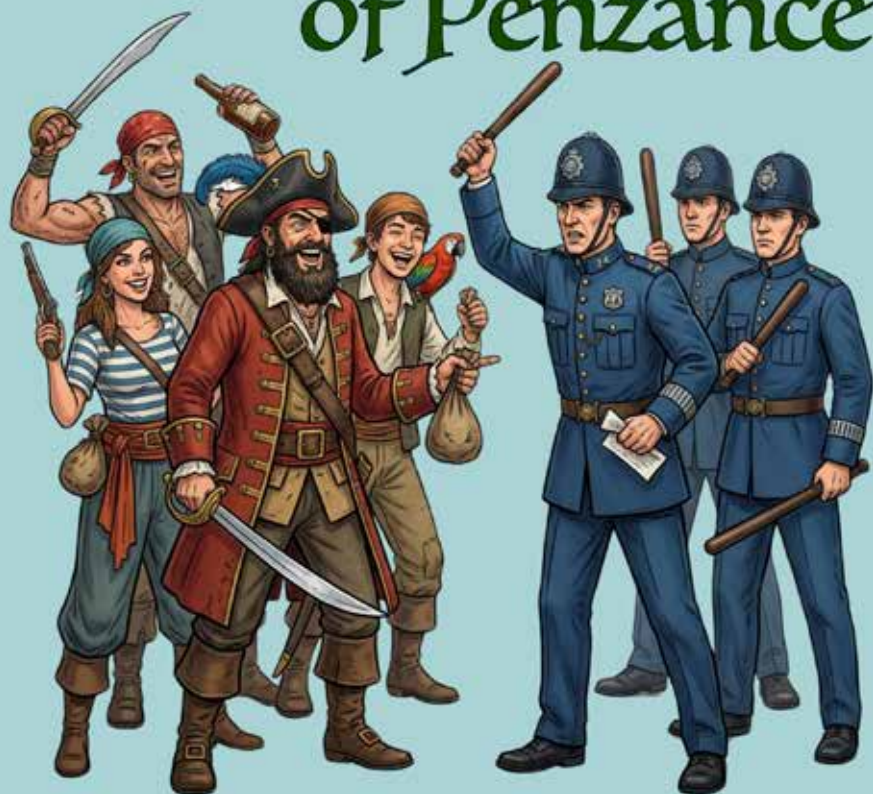
KINGTON
&
DISTRICT
Community
Shop

- | | |
|---------|--------------------------|
| 07-Oct: | Eardisley Primary School |
| 14-Oct: | Lady Hawkins School PTFA |
| 21-Oct: | Kington Choral Society |
| 28-Oct: | Presteigne 1st Scouts |

Kington & District Operatic Society presents...

Gilbert & Sullivan's

The Pirates of Penzance



Lady Hawkins' Community Leisure Centre

Thu 29th Oct ~ 7:30 Fri 30th Oct ~ 7:30 Sat 31st Oct ~ 2:30

Tickets from The Burton Hotel and ticketsource.co.uk/kados

Adults ~ £12 Under 18s ~ £6

kingtonoperatic.co.uk

Not a Proper Gardener

Emma's birds have recently been attacked and some picked off, by a sparrowhawk, and the other day the naughty bird got stuck in some netting. Emma managed to release it, for which it was not at all grateful. It swooped up onto some trellis and gave her the evil eye before flying off and has subsequently enlisted its wife to join it in its wicked ways. Recently in my morning service I had read that we should not resist evil with evil but overcome evil with good (Romans 12.29-21). So I congratulated Emma for her releasing it while admitting that I, miserable sinner that I am, would simply have bonked it on the head. (I hadn't any coals of fire handy!)

The other livestock event concerns the three hedgehogs. Emma had put out their calci worms on a large lid in the yard, placing a heavy tile on it to prevent it from blowing away. It was not so far from her bedroom window, and early after dark she heard a thumping noise as the exceedingly hungry creatures were playing tiddly-winks with the tile, probably hoping to find bits of food stuck underneath it. So hungry? Surely, they are not preparing to hibernate just yet? And next morning an excited Emma burst into the kitchen exclaiming, "There were five of them last night!!"

But the most important thing to record for the past month is the rain, coming as I predicted 40 or so days after a dry St Swithin's! It's amazing how the grass is greening, even in our jungle, a hayfield where the mower has been out only a couple of times this year. The general reduction of excessive heat has meant some things are improving. The runner beans, for example, have been setting at last. The plums and damsons are producing plentifully, as are the mulberries. Our lettuce are coming on well, and Emma's been able to plant out various winter greens, to be protected from too many white butterflies. Lots of huckleberries have overgrown one lot



of French beans and some beetroot. Giles is string boy when she spends time sorting out new canes – boysenberries etc. And I should mention the tomatoes, Maisie. The ones outside are doing twice as well as those in the greenhouse, which suffered, we suspect from the excessive heat. The chocolate cherry ones have done quite well, but disappoint Giles because they taste neither of chocolate nor of cherries nor, for that matter, of tomatoes!

The saddest effect of the heatwaves has been to ruin the chance of any apple crop and to weaken the pears. The apples have been simply falling off stressed trees before ripening, and the third of our ancient trees is giving up. Are we going to have a hard winter, I wonder?

Happy gardening, Denis.

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal
in a friendly environment with
other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

(HR5 3AG)

at 12:30 p.m.

Cost is £6

We meet on the
3rd Wednesday of each month.

Next lunch is on 21st October

Contact: Rose: 01544 230174

OAK | Open Arms Kingston September events

Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kingston, October 2026.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.



Saturday 3rd October, 11am-4pm. *Make Your Mark:* an art and craft event for The Big Draw with workshops and an art and craft market. Check our website for the latest details. Free.

Tuesday 6th October, 4-5.30pm. *Rural Voices* creative sessions for young people aged 12+ in association with Rural Media, session 3 of 4. Toni and Buchanan from Rural Media support young people to express themselves through making animations, zines, and more.

Free but booking required, contact Toni at ToniC@ruralmedia.co.uk or via WhatsApp on 07799 814215.

Wednesday 7th October, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome.* A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Tuesday 13th October, 4-5.30pm. *Rural Voices* creative sessions for young people aged 12+ in association with Rural Media, session 4 of 4. Toni and Buchanan from Rural Media support young people to express themselves through making animations, zines, and more.

Free but booking required, contact Toni at ToniC@ruralmedia.co.uk or via WhatsApp on 07799 814215.

Wednesday 14th October, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome.* Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Sunday 25th October, 12-4pm. *Community Apple Pressing with KLEEN + Creative Workshop.*

Bring washed apples and clean containers to press your own apple juice. This month's Creative Workshop focuses on wax resist leaf journals, payment by donation (£5 suggested). Bar and café open 12-4pm.

Saturday 31st October, from 4pm. *Halloween.* We'll have music, a quiz, activities for kids and our bar will be open. Check our website for the latest details. Free.



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News From the Museum

Kington Show

I found minutes from the Kington Horticultural Society from June 1893, which made some interesting reading, covering the tenders for the supply of a tent, tables etc. for the sum of £5 10 shillings. Accepted subject to the table's easels being sufficient. The Hereford Volunteers band of 18 performers were engaged for £9 9 shillings to entertain the public; the band have travelled by train to Kington and no doubt marched from the station to the Recreation Ground. Stewards were appointed to act in conjunction with the athletic sports. The horticultural side had displays of plants, vegetables, fruit and Cottagers. What the Cottagers section was it was not described.

By February 1926 the show fixed for September, the class schedule was revised with onions and apples being 5 instead of 6, dahlias replacing carnations, begonias for geraniums and the introduction of beetroot. A reduction of a shilling in prize monies for the shallot class. It reflects the new and popularity of flowers.

It was proposed to hold the show at Hergest Croft with a new section for industry with the Mrs's Edwards, Robinson, Vaughan and Oliver appointed to arrange this new venture, but not to spend more than £5 on the classes for the children. An application for a grant to The County Council was made, to fund the Best Cottage Garden. I have no idea what the schedule detailed, but maybe a garden on a plate or maybe a mini-Chelsea Show Garden? The show had sponsors too with the medals provided by "Gardening Illustrated" magazine and Hereford Corn Exchange the honey class. Nurserymen were invited to stage a display for interest.

At the March 1926 General meeting the future of the Society was discussed due to lack of

interest, support and funds, a decision was taken to defer the winding up of the society for a year. It was also proposed to hold the show in conjunction with the Annual Sports held on the recreation Ground which had no seconder.

1 year on saw the Officers were asked to retain their position and issue a circular titled "*Kington Horticultural Society – founded 1859*" *Suspension of Annual flower*

The Committee regret that owing to lack of funds, they do not see their way to hold a Flower Show this year, but trust that sufficient support will be forthcoming to enable them to revive the show in 1928.

The Midland Bank and the Honorary Secretary are authorised to receive Subscription with this end in view.

A Dillow. Hon. Sec. Gravel |hill, Kington 7th March 1927.

Looking at history, it was the time of the "Depression".

The Annual General Meeting in 1928 proposed agenda was:

To wind the society up. Donate the remaining funds to the Sports Committee on condition they hold the Flower Show in 1928. Members of the committee be appointed to co-operate with the Sports committee. Subscriptions received to be returned forthwith, or the balance equally divided with the Cottage Hospital.

Kington Show continues to evolve, receive the support and popularity it deserves.

Wendy Jones

**For all advertising enquiries
please contact:**

pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Brilley Flicks in the Sticks & Live Performance

Thursday 1st October at 7.30: One Battle After Another (cert 15), £5

A superb action-packed thriller, laced with humour and inventiveness. Washed-up revolutionary Bob (Leonardo DiCaprio) exists in a state of stoned paranoia, surviving off grid with his spirited, self-reliant daughter, Willa. When his evil nemesis resurfaces after 16 years and Willa goes missing, the former radical scrambles to find her, father and daughter both battling the consequences of his past. Based on the Thomas Pynchon novel Vineland, the film pits the politics of counterculture against the forces of reaction with manic energy. This is a film to be watched on the big screen, not least for the magnificent car chase sequence. 'It's impossible to overstate how much fun this thing is.' Baltimore Magazine

Thursday 5th November at 7.30: The Trouble with Jessica (15), £5

A British satirical dark comedy about successful professional London couple Sarah and Tom, who are in deep financial trouble. Their situation takes a terrifying nosedive with the shocking behaviour of uninvited dinner guest, Jessica. Faced with the moral dilemma of their lives - and dragging their best friends Richard and Beth with them - they make a series of choices that could either be their salvation or destruction.

And looking ahead:

Thursday 3rd December at 7.30: Midwinter Break (12A), £5

Thursday 7th January at 7.30: Rebuilding (PG), £5

Brilley and Michaelchurch Village Hall (HR3 6JG), doors open at 7pm. Don't forget to bring your own refreshments!

As usual advance booking only - please book and pay for your tickets online at pay-brilley.co.uk

Easy Sudoku

			2	4		
4	8		7	9	5	6
6			3		9	2
1				2	6	9
		5			8	
	9	6	1			2
	2	8		5		9
5		1	2	6		8
		3	7			

Intermediate Sudoku

	1	6	7			
		8		5		9
			3			5
5			1		7	8
3		6	7			4
	2		4			
			5		6	
			9	3		2

Caring for God's Acre

Why Waxcaps?

Imagine yourself in a gorgeous churchyard on the turn of Summer into Autumn. The days shorten, the air chills, the leaves crunch underfoot. Taking a deep breath, you smell the damp earth and rich soil beneath your feet. You walk through the grass and stumble across something small yet mighty, a sign that the meadow you're in is doing wonderful things to help safeguard species-rich grasslands for the future. You're looking at a Waxcap mushroom and we need your help to find them and record them!

Our friends at Plantlife are running their annual Waxcap Watch, a citizen science programme asking you to record what fungi you see in grasslands this Autumn. Among lots of other wondrous flora, Waxcaps are often found in churchyards and burial grounds. They favour low nutrient soils that are regularly managed for species rich grassland. The loss of traditional management elsewhere has meant that these pockets in managed churchyards are even more important for the survival of waxcaps.

Many of our grassland fungi species are common in the UK but are highly threatened globally. Some are even classed as vulnerable on the IUCN Red List; the same threat level as Giant Pandas and Snow leopards. There are around 50 species of waxcap, and the majority are recognisable for their bright colours, but are often small and can get lost in the sward. So, how do you get involved in this year's Waxcap Watch survey?

The survey season takes place between Sept and Nov, when all the fungi should be out and easily visible. You don't need any fungi ID skills or specialism to take part in these



surveys. All you need is a smartphone or access to a computer. However, if you'd like to brush up on your Waxcap knowledge, or get a good introduction to grassland fungi, Plantlife have a series of free online training courses for you.

Visit Plantlife's page for more information and full instructions on downloading the app and starting your surveys

You can survey any grassy area open to the public (or site you have gained permission to access). The best way to start is by walking over an area in a slow zig-zag pattern so you give yourself time to spot the fungi. Some species can be small and elusive, so it might take you a while to get your eye in!

It's vital we protect these important species and their delicate but beautiful habitat.

Where waxcaps live, continued traditional management will help conserve them. Things like scything and removing the grass cuttings are fantastic methods of keeping grasslands fungi friendly. Feeds and fertilisers should be avoided at all cost!

If you visit a local churchyard to complete your Waxcap watch, we'd love to hear from you. Please take lots of photos of what you find. We'd love to see what's being found and hear how you've got on in your local burial ground.

Kaitlyn Elverson

Engagement Officer, Nature in Sacred Places Project (NiSP)

KINGTON TOWN COUNCIL UPDATE



October update

As I prepare this article it is good to see that works on the Market Hall, Coach house and Place de Marines has begun. These works should not only see the front of the Market Hall repaired but will also see a new roof on the Coach House and the cover to the Place de Marines should be cleaned and renovated. It will be good to see the buildings back in a good condition and able to be used by the community.

Further works are being undertaken to the pavements in Bridge Street, and we are waiting to hear when the lighting to the far end of the Bridge is to be completed. Finally in October we hope to have the centre of town delineated by a change of colour of road surface. This we hope will not only create a 'Town centre' feel but will also have the effect of slowing down traffic.

Talking of speeding traffic, we have had formal notification that our wish for Kington to become a 20MPH zone has been received and will be considered at an annual review, we wait the outcome with interest.

Further projects underway

are new signage for the entry points into the town and negotiations are beginning over the Town council taking responsibility for the public toilets! This will be a major project for us but, as it is probably the most complained about part of town, and one we have to rely on Herefordshire Council to maintain, we feel it is an amenity that we should be in control of.

We will keep you informed of progress.

Martin Woolford

Mayor: Kington Town Council

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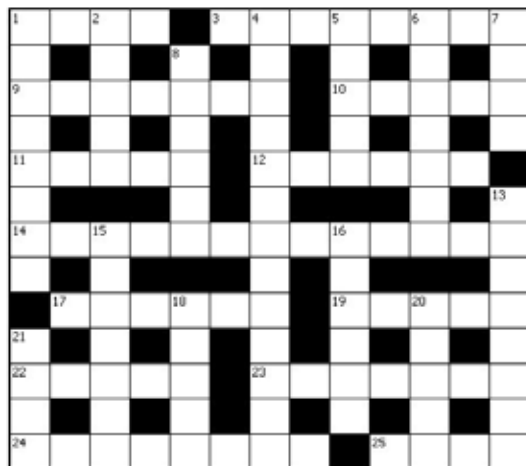


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Kington Local Environment & Energy Network (KLEEN)

Contact: Jon Cooke 07776 236823 - Email: kingtonkleen@gmail.com - Visit: kingtonkleen.org.uk

October Crossword



Across

- 1 'Those who were standing near Paul said, "You — to insult God's high priest?"' (Acts 23:4) (4)
- 3 They were assigned to guard the tree of life (Genesis 3:24) (8)
- 9 'Elkanah son of Jeroham, the son of Elihu, the — of — , the son of Zuph, an Ephraimite' (1 Samuel 1:1) (3,4)
- 10 Surrender (Joshua 24:23) (5)
- 11 Where American livestock can be reared (5)
- 12 Listen (anag.) (6)
- 14 Alternative name for Kiriath Jearim (2 Samuel 6:2) (6,2,5)
- 17 He founded Westminster Abbey, — the Confessor (6)
- 19 Hebrew word for the place of the dead (5)
- 22 Allies of Persia in the fifth century BC (Esther 1:3) (5)
- 23 Where John Wesley was forced to preach a lot (4,3)
- 24 Rebellion against God; abandonment of religious belief (8)
- 25 Note (anag.) (4)

Down

- 1 Give an account of (Mark 4:30) (8)
- 2 'I — the path of your commands, for you have set my heart free' (Psalm 119:32) (3,2)
- 4 'He took the ephod, the other — — and the carved image' (Judges 18:20) (9,4)
- 5 'You are a chosen people, a — priesthood' (1 Peter 2:9) (5)
- 6 The meek, the merciful and the mourners are all this (Matthew 5:4–5, 7) (7)
- 7 Musical Instrument Digital Interface (1,1,1,1)
- 8 He was the son of Nun (Deuteronomy 34:9) (6)
- 13 'Let the little — come to me' (Matthew 19:14) (8)
- 15 'About three thousand were — — their number that day' (Acts 2:41) (5,2)
- 16 In John's vision, the wall of the new Jerusalem was made of this (Revelation 21:18) (6)
- 18 'Our citizenship is in heaven. And we eagerly — a Saviour from there, the Lord Jesus Christ' (Philippians 3:20) (5)
- 20 'Glorify the Lord with me: let us — his name together' (Psalm 34:3) (5)
- 21 Young Men's Christian Association (1,1,1,1)

Please see page 22 for answers

Answers Page

Easy Sudoku

3	5	9	6	2	8	4	7	1
4	8	2	7	1	9	5	3	6
6	1	7	3	5	4	9	2	8
1	7	4	5	8	2	6	9	3
2	3	5	9	6	7	8	1	4
8	9	6	1	4	3	7	5	2
7	2	8	4	3	5	1	6	9
5	4	1	2	9	6	3	8	7
9	6	3	8	7	1	2	4	5

Intermediate Sudoku

2	1	5	6	9	7	8	4	3
7	3	8	4	2	5	1	9	6
9	6	4	1	3	8	2	5	7
5	9	2	3	1	4	7	6	8
4	7	1	8	5	6	9	3	2
3	8	6	2	7	9	5	1	4
6	2	9	7	4	1	3	8	5
1	4	3	5	8	2	6	7	9
8	5	7	9	6	3	4	2	1

Crossword

D	A	R	E		C	H	E	R	U	B	I	M
E		U		J		O		O		L		I
S	O	N	T	O	H	U		Y	I	E	L	D
C		I		S		S		A		S		I
R	A	N	C	H			E	N	L	I	S	T
I				U		H				E		C
B	A	A	L	A	H	O	F	J	U	D	A	H
E		D				L		A				I
	E	D	W	A	R	D		S	H	E	O	L
Y		E		W		G		P		X		D
M	E	D	I	A			O	P	E	N	A	I
C		T		I		D		R		L		E
A	P	O	S	T	A	S	Y		E	T	O	N

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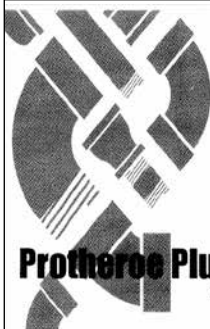
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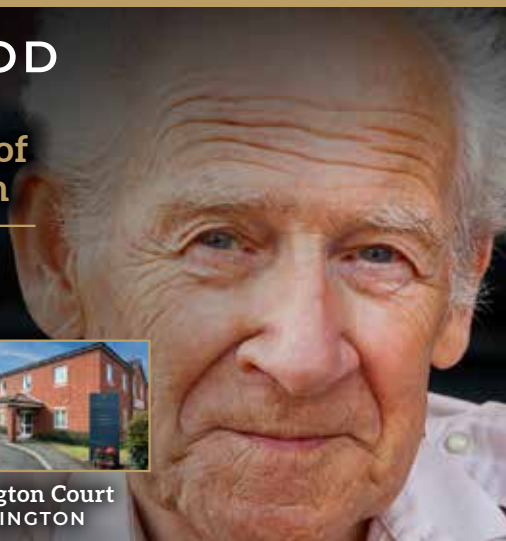
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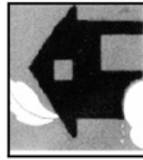
Knighton Library

41	41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30	
06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39	
06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05	
	08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-	

41	41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03	
06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07	
07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27	
07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37	

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Forthcoming events

<i>October</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Fri 2 nd	10.00– 11.00 am	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated Weekly</i>			
Fri 2 nd	11.30 – 13.30	Kington Food Bank	Parish Hall
Sat 3 rd Oct	12 noon	Huntington Chase	Huntington Village Hall
		https://www.huntingtonchurch.co.uk/chase-2026	£15
Sun 4 th	11.00 am	Harvest Festival	St Mary's
Sun 4 th	6.00 pm	Prayer and Praise Evening	St Mary's
Sun 4 th	6.00 pm	Harvest Festival	Old Radnor
Mon 5 th	12.15 – 1.00 pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated Weekly</i>			
Tues 6 th	9.15 – 10.45	Stay & Play	Parish Hall
<i>Every Tuesday in term time</i> (Parents, carers and children aged 0 – 3)			
Tues 6 th	2 – 3 pm	Marches Voices Choir (all welcome)	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated Weekly</i>			
Tues 6 th	7.00 pm	St Mary's PCC	Parish Hall
Fri 9 th	6.00 pm	Harvest Festival, Supper & Sale	Kinnerton Church
Sun 11 th		Hergest Croft Plant Sale	Hergest Croft
Sun 11 th	11.00 am	Harvest Festival	Huntington URC Church
Tues 13 th	7.00 pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Fri 16 th	7.00 pm	'A Jug of Punch' Concert	St Mary's £12 (under 18s free)
Sat 17 th	10 – 12	Coffee Morning @ The Dove / Yarn Barn	37 High St, Kington
Wed 21 st	3.30 pm	Lego Club	St Mary's
Sun 25 th	6.00 pm	Choral Evensong	Huntington Church
		<i>(rehearsal 5.00 pm, tea 5.30)</i>	
Fri 30 th	6.00 pm	Harvest Festival	Titley
Sat 31 st		Kington Museum closes until the spring	Kington Museum

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 3

*You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in
Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com and www.visitherefordshire.co.uk*

*If you would like a church or community event publicised in the Diary please contact the
Diary Editor: Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com*

MATERIAL FOR THE NOVEMBER 2026 PARISH NEWS

by **10th October 2026**

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:

pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Note: The cut-off date is always the 10th of the previous month